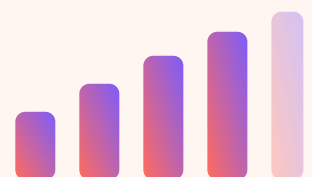


• FREE EDUCATIONAL GUIDE

How to start investing

The essentials gathered in one place —
made for people who are truly just
starting.

No products.
No promises.



ABOUT THIS GUIDE

Everything you need to take the first step — without the noise.

This ebook brings together, in one place, the core ideas for anyone truly starting to invest. It is organised into short modules, from the right mindset to building your first plan. Read in order or jump to what you need — it is all open.

We sell nothing and make no promises of return. Examples are always by *asset class*, never specific products.

7

guided modules

~75

minutes of reading

0

products sold

IMPORTANT NOTICE

Purely educational content about financial literacy. Nothing here is financial, investment, tax or legal advice, nor a recommendation to buy or sell. Investing involves risk, including the possible loss of capital. Past performance does not guarantee future results. Examples are illustrative and by asset class only. Before deciding, consider your own situation and, if needed, seek independent professional advice.

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How to use this guide

Read in order if you are truly starting — each module builds on the last. If you already know the basics, jump to what interests you. There are no deadlines: go at your own pace.



KEY IDEA

The sentence to take from each chapter. If you only read this, you have already gained something.



EXAMPLE

An illustrative case, always by asset class — never a specific product.



CAUTION

A common mistake or a trap to avoid before it costs you money.



TERM

An underlined word you will find explained in the glossary, at the end of the guide.

THE PATH

Seven modules, one idea at a time

~75 min total

00

01

02

03

04

05

06

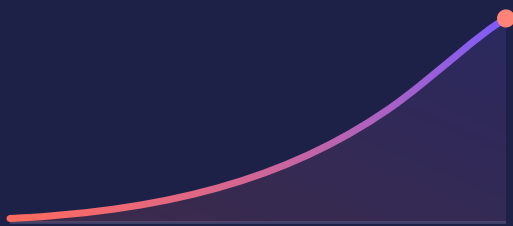
Saving protects. Investing grows.

Setting money aside is the first step, and it is essential — it is your safety net. But idle money loses value every year, eaten away by inflation. Investing means putting part of that money to work, so time plays for you instead of against you.

You do not need to be an expert, to have a lot of money, or to predict the market. You need to understand a handful of ideas and be consistent. That is exactly what this guide gives you.

THE POWER OF TIME

Compound interest works while you sleep



The earlier you start, the less effort the rest demands.

OUR PROMISE

No products. No promises.

- ✓ We sell nothing and take no commissions.
- ✓ We never promise returns or tell you what to buy.
- ✓ We only explain the basics, in plain language.

KEY IDEA

Investing well is, above all, starting early, keeping it simple, and not interrupting time.

00

Mindset & money

Before the charts and the complicated names, what counts is the right relationship with risk, time and your goals.

IN THIS MODULE

-
- | | | |
|---|--------------------------------|-------|
| 1 | Why saving isn't enough | 4 min |
| 2 | Risk and time: your two allies | 5 min |
-

01 Why saving isn't enough

Saving is the foundation of everything. Without a reserve, any surprise turns into debt. But there is a silent problem: money sitting in an account loses buying power year after year. That is called inflation — and it is why saving, on its own, is not enough.

€1,000 sitting idle, over 10 years

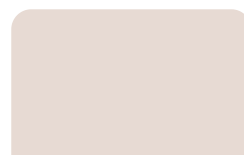
~2.5%/yr average inflation

€1,000



Today

~€781



In 10 years

Even without spending a cent, what that money buys shrinks. Illustrative figures.

The answer is not to stop saving — it is to split money by purpose. One part stays liquid, for emergencies and near-term goals. Another part, the money you will not need soon, can be invested to grow above inflation.

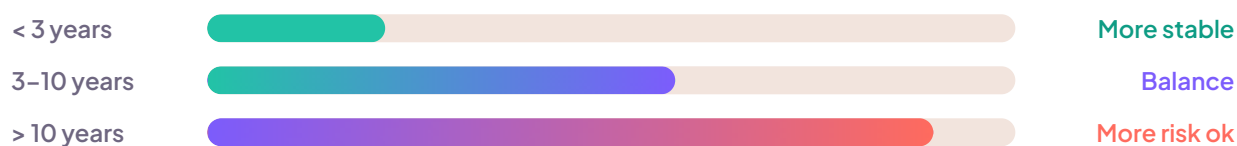
KEY IDEA

Saving keeps your money; investing stops inflation from eating it.

02 Risk and time: your two allies

Risk is scary, but it is not the enemy — it is the price of any return above inflation. The trick is to pair it with your time horizon: the further away the goal, the more ups and downs you can ride out along the way.

How long until you need the money?



With more time, there is room to recover from drops — which is why the horizon changes what makes sense.

EXAMPLE

Money for a car in 2 years asks for stability.
Money for retirement, 30 years out, can take far more swing.

CAUTION

Too much risk for a near-term goal can force you to sell at the worst moment. Always match it to the timeframe.

What you take from this module

- 1 Saving is the base, but idle money loses value to inflation. Investing is how your money grows above it.
- 2 Risk is not the enemy — it is the price of return. What makes it sensible (or not) is your time horizon.
- 3 Split money by purpose: a liquid reserve for the short term, invested money for the long term.

TERMS IN THIS MODULE

Inflation

Time horizon

Liquidity

Emergency fund



A QUESTION FOR YOU

Which part of your money won't you truly need in the next five years?

01

Fundamentals

The core ideas that hold up everything else — compound interest, inflation, and the link between liquidity and time.

IN THIS MODULE

- | | | |
|---|-------------------------------------|-------|
| 1 | Compound interest, explained calmly | 5 min |
| 2 | Inflation: the invisible tax | 4 min |
| 3 | Liquidity and time horizon | 4 min |

01 Compound interest, explained calmly

It is the most powerful idea of all — and the simplest. Compound interest is earning a return not only on what you invested, but also on the return that has already built up. Gains start generating their own gains.



Notice the curve: at the start it barely differs from a straight line. It only takes off near the end. That is why the most valuable ingredient is not having a lot of money — it is giving **time** to the process.

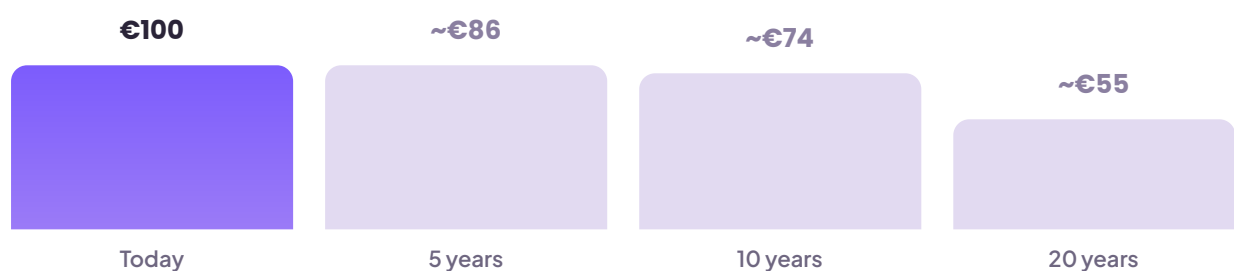
KEY IDEA

Time is the engine of compound interest. Starting early is worth more than starting big.

02 Inflation: the invisible tax

Nobody charges you inflation directly, but it takes buying power from you every year. If prices rise 3% and your money sits idle, you became 3% poorer without spending a thing. It is the tax that never shows on a receipt.

What €100 buys over time (inflation ~3%/yr)



EXAMPLE

A €1 coffee today will cost close to €1.34 in 10 years at 3% inflation. The price went up; your idle money did not.

CAUTION

"I didn't lose money, it's all in the account" is an illusion. In buying power, idle money almost always loses.

03 Liquidity and time horizon

Liquidity is how quickly you can turn something into cash without losing value. Money in an account is very liquid; property is not. Cross this with your horizon and you see where to place each euro.

From most to least liquid

Account / deposit	Bonds	Equities	Property
Instant	Days	Days	Months

The less liquid it is, the more time (and patience) the asset tends to ask for.

Rule of thumb: money you might need at any moment stays liquid; money with years ahead can go to less-liquid assets, which tend to reward that wait.

KEY IDEA

Pair liquidity and horizon: near money liquid and stable; distant money put to work.

What you take from this module

- 1 Compound interest makes gains generate gains. The curve takes off at the end, so time is the most valuable ingredient.
- 2 Inflation erodes idle money every year. Investing is how you try to grow above it.
- 3 Liquidity and horizon go together: short-term money stays accessible; long-term money can earn more.

TERMS IN THIS MODULE

Compound interest

Inflation

Buying power

Liquidity



A QUESTION FOR YOU

If you started today with little, but every month, where would you be in 20 years?

Your first steps

Knowing is half of it; the other half is doing. Here is a simple sequence to move from reading to action — no rush.

- 1 Secure your **emergency fund** before investing.
- 2 Write down **goal, timeframe and monthly amount** on your plan sheet.
- 3 Set your **target allocation** according to your horizon.
- 4 **Automate** regular contributions and keep costs low.
- 5 **Stay the course** and re-read your plan on down days.



CONTINUE IN THE APP

Discover your profile and follow the guided path

Point your camera at the code to open HowToInvest. A profile quiz, modules and an interactive glossary — free and with no products for sale.

Starting is the hardest step.

You took it by reading this far. Now it is about keeping it simple, regular and patient. Time handles the rest.

No products. No promises.

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